Joshua York

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Research and Teaching Fields

Macroeconomics and Monetary Economics

My research focuses on the formation/implications of household beliefs/expectations with respect to monetary policy. I am interested in both qualitative and quantitative expectations of households.

Starting in Fall 2024, I will be joining the department of economics at Grand Valley State University as an Assistant Professor.

Education

Texas A&M University — College Station, Texas
Ph.D Candidate in Economics — Expected: Spring 2024
Committee: Dr. Sarah Zubairy (*co-chair*)
Dr. Tatevik Sekhposyan (*co-chair*)
Dr. Yoon Jo

University of Wisconsin — Madison, Wisconsin
M.S. in Economics — Fall 2018

Purdue University — West Lafayette, Indiana
B.S. in Honors Economics — Spring 2017

Working Papers

(JMP): Do Household Inflation Expectations Respond to Macroeconomic Data Releases?

This paper investigates how household inflation expectations respond to macroeconomic data releases. By utilizing an unexploited feature of the Michigan Survey of Consumers (MSC) – the interview dates of each respondent between June 1979 and May 2019 – I identify whether respondent expectations differ within tight windows around data releases. I consider 480 monthly releases of the Employment Situation Summary (ESS), Consumer Price Index (CPI), Industrial Production (IP), and Gross Domestic Product (GDP), as well as 459 Federal Open Market Committee (FOMC) meetings/calls. I find that household inflation expectations significantly respond to information about the unemployment rate and CPI inflation, suggesting salience of these variables for households relative to others considered. This includes the size and sign of the data release relative to the previous period data release. With 40 years of interviews, this paper also addresses whether the relevance of these releases differs during recessions. I find that information about the unemployment rate is particularly salient preceding, during, and following recessions. For a shorter subsample, this paper concludes with whether deviations in these releases from market expectations, as measured by the Bloomberg consensus forecasts, prompts adjustment. I find that household inflation expectations respond to deviations in IP and real GDP growth, indicating that unanticipated changes in output growth are relevant.

Does Consumer Sentiment Matter for Monetary Policy?

I find evidence that monetary policy shocks have very little effect on consumer sentiment, even when conditioning on states of inflation, business cycles, and interest rates. However, I do find evidence that the state of consumer sentiment does matter for the propagation of monetary policy shocks to output, inflation, and unemployment. Specifically, positive interest rate shocks during periods of depressed consumer sentiment have quicker and more contractionary effects on output and unemployment, while inflation is not responsive over short nor long term horizons.

Teaching Experience

Introductory microeconomics — Spring 2020, Fall 2019 – Fall 2023
Undergraduate, TA for Dr. Jonathan Meer and Dr. Steve Wiggins

Intermediate macroeconomic theory — Spring 2024
Undergraduate, TA for Dr. Yuzhe Zhang

Introductory macroeconomics — Summer 2023
Undergraduate, Primary Instructor

Intermediate macroeconomic theory — Spring 2023
Undergraduate, Primary Instructor

Financial Economics — Spring 2022
Undergraduate, TA for Dr. Dennis Jansen

Macroeconomic Theory II — Spring 2021
Graduate, TA for Dr. Sarah Zubairy

Industrial Organization — Fall 2020
Undergraduate, TA for Dr. Steve Wiggins

Professional Experience

White House Council of Economic Advisers (CEA) — Jan 2019 – Aug 2019, Summer 2018
Research Economist – International Trade

TDS Telecommunications — Aug 2017 – May 2018, Fall 2018
Internal Application Developer

U.S. Department of Defense — Summer 2017, Summer 2016
Financial Analyst on Foreign Currency Accounts

Indiana State Senate — Spring 2016
Legislative Assistant for Chairs of Judiciary and Public Policy committees

Other

Conferences
2023: *Texas Macro Conference, Southern Economic Association*
2020: *Stanford King Center on Global Development*

Awards
Outstanding Graduate Student Course Instructor, Fall 2023
Graduate Assistantship, Texas A&M University, 2019 – 2024

Service
Economics Graduate Student Association, Texas A&M University, Fall 2022 – Spring 2023

Technical Skills
Stata, Matlab, Python, R, Excel, Latex, Java, HTML, SQL

References

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Dr. Jonathan Meer
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